

Alvaro LOPEZ

alvaro@gnu.org

Miami, United States
Phone: (978) 996-2393

Engineering Executive
Hyperscale Infrastructure
Open Source Strategy



Executive Summary

Infrastructure Executive

Global technology leader with over 20 years of experience bridging deep technical engineering with P&L strategy. I build and transform organizations that run the world's largest systems, aligning technical execution with multi-billion dollar capital investments to drive revenue and efficiency. Previously, as **Head of Engineering** at Docker, I orchestrated the turnaround that fueled **3x business growth**.

Current Roles

As Director of Cloud Platform at **Pinterest**, I oversee the strategy for a **\$3.25B AWS** commitment supporting 600 million users. I drive Cloud Architecture and Operations, recently delivering **\$125M in annual savings** and launching PinCompute, a Kubernetes platform handling 5,000+ monthly ML training jobs.

Concurrently, I serve on the **Technical Advisory Board of Inditex** (parent company of Zara, **€39.9B** revenue with a 20.1% operating margin). In this capacity, I advise the C-Suite on a **€2.7B digital transformation**, guiding global cloud architecture and "build-vs-buy" decisions for a network of 6,400+ stores.

Technical Credibility

Tens of millions of devices run code I personally wrote. I have been a GNU maintainer for 23 years and created Cherokee Web Server, deployed on the **International Space Station** and in every **GoPro** camera. I also **founded the Presto Foundation**, uniting Meta, Uber, and Alibaba to establish industry-wide data access standards.

I combine high-level strategic vision with deep technical expertise, ensuring that multi-year roadmaps are grounded in engineering reality. I bridge the gap between corporate objectives and low-level execution, validating architectural decisions from kernel contributions to platforms at **exabyte scale**.

Background

PhD in Telecommunications and **M.Sc. in Artificial Intelligence**, complemented by Executive Education at the **University of Chicago Booth School of Business**. I also served for 5 years as an Industry Mentor at **MIT** (Performance Engineering), guiding the next generation of architects in building scalable systems.

Global Reach

Dual **US-EU Citizenship** (USA and Spanish), providing full work authorization in the US and Europe, and the cultural command to lead across **AMER, EMEA, and LATAM**. I have built and managed distributed organizations of **120+ engineers** across the US, Europe, and APAC, including navigating complex geopolitical landscapes for teams in China to unify global talent and deliver round-the-clock engineering velocity.

Professional Experience

Inditex: Technical Board - Advisor

Mar 2025

Serving on the Technical Advisory Board for the world's largest fashion retailer (€29.9B revenue with a 20.1% operating margin), parent company of Zara, Massimo Dutti, and Pull & Bear among others.

- **Executive Governance:** Partnering with the Board members and C-Suite to steer a €2.7B digital transformation, defining the hybrid strategy across Data Centers, Public Cloud, and the Edge computing footprint in 6,400+ stores.
- **AI Strategy:** Shaping the strategic adoption of Artificial Intelligence, advising leadership on high-impact use cases that drive internal operational efficiency and improve the customer experience.

Pinterest: Director of Engineering - Cloud Infrastructure

Jan 2024

Leading the Cloud Platform organization and Capacity Engineering for a user base of 600M MAU, managing a \$3.25B AWS commitment and infrastructure supporting 300B+ Pins and 1 Exabyte of data.

- **Financial Strategy & Cost Optimization:** Managing daily infrastructure spend of \$1.8M. Delivered \$125M in infrastructure savings for FY2025 through aggressive capacity engineering and leveraging strategic commercial agreements (ISP/CSP/ODCR) to capture deep sustained discounts on committed spend.
- **Architecture & Modernization:** Directed the migration to AWS Graviton, achieving 47% cost savings and 62% carbon reduction per API request. Leading the unification of compute platforms onto a global, federated Kubernetes (EKS) infrastructure orchestrating 1.48M deployments per month across 1.32M containers.
- **AI/ML Infrastructure:** Launched PinCompute, a Kubernetes-based cloud platform scaling to handle 5,000+ ML training jobs monthly, anchoring the company's multi-year compute strategy and enabling the ML Platform, Ads, and Finance teams to execute multi-year growth strategies.
- **Organizational Leadership:** Evolved team culture, improving organization health metrics to an 8% detractor rate (best-in-class) while executing a migration roadmap unifying instance types and compute platforms.

eBay: Sr. Director of Engineering & Product - Cloud, Traffic, Edge Infrastructure

Aug 2021 - Nov 2023

Led a dual Engineering & Product organization of 120+ staff across the US, Europe, and China. Owned the end-to-end production infrastructure (1.2M pods, 150k servers) supporting 175M buyers and \$74B in GMV.

- **Capital Expenditure Strategy:** Managed an annual CAPEX budget of \$460M, delivering \$600M/year in value by strategizing a proprietary server-build program vs. public cloud (GCP) procurement to maximize margin.
- **AI & Resiliency:** Introduced NVIDIA AI supercomputers for large-scale ML training and maintained 99.98% availability while managing massive organic growth, including a 105% surge in bot traffic and 18% increase in API requests.
- **Security Architecture:** Orchestrated the transition from IP-based segmentation to service-based micro-segmentation (eBPF/Istio), securing a supply chain processing 300B daily data queries while establishing a Zero Trust posture across 3,000 distributed applications.
- **Global Operations Strategy:** Mitigated critical geopolitical risk for the Shanghai-based engineering center, executing a continuity plan that secured throughput and retained key talent, insulating the business from escalating US-China tensions while ensuring zero operational downtime.

Docker: Head of Engineering

May 2020 - Aug 2021

Led Engineering, SRE, and Customer Support for the world's largest Container Repository during a critical corporate turnaround. Direct report to the CEO.

- **Turnaround & Growth:** Orchestrated the engineering transformation that fueled **3x business growth**, driving revenue from **\$11M to \$20M ARR** within 15 months.
- **Ecosystem Expansion:** Cultivated strategic technology partnerships with **AWS, Microsoft Azure, and Snyk**, aligning product roadmaps to expand the Docker ecosystem.
- **Global Operations:** Established a new European engineering hub, integrating Leadership, Product, and UX roles to optimize a fully remote, distributed workforce.

Meta: Leadership - Big Data

Mar 2019 - Dec 2019

Directed critical initiatives within the **Data Infrastructure** Leadership Team, managing systems processing **300+ PB of data** to power interactive, low-latency analytics for critical business operations.

- **Industry Governance:** Founded the **Presto Foundation** (Linux Foundation), leading high-stakes negotiations to secure **Uber, Twitter, and Alibaba** as founding members while driving strategic adoption talks with **Netflix, Amazon, and LinkedIn**.
- **Big Data Architecture:** Led **Presto Engineering** and the **Data Exploration R&D group**, delivering the distributed SQL engine used for critical business operations while pioneering novel sampling techniques for low-latency analytics at **exabyte scale**.

Akamai: Director of Engineering - Distributed Platform

Jun 2017 - Mar 2019

Reported to the CTO within Akamai Labs (**Office of the CTO**), leading the modernization of the Distributed Platform that serves **30% of global web traffic** across **250,000+ servers** in **130+ countries**.

- **Platform Modernization:** Built and led the global engineering group responsible for replacing legacy architecture with a cloud-native **Kubernetes** solution, supporting **3+ trillion daily interactions** and **96 Exabytes monthly**.
- **Strategic Transformation:** Directed large-scale infrastructure orchestration initiatives and defined Akamai's corporate **Open Source strategy**, driving the cultural and technical shift toward cloud-native principles across the enterprise.

Red Hat: Global Manager - Cloud Infrastructure R&D

Oct 2012 - Jun 2017

Manager of Managers for global R&D teams (**NA, EMEA, APAC**) focused on **OpenStack** and **Cloud Infrastructure**, while overseeing the **RDO community** and **distribution strategy**.

- **Market Expansion & Operations:** Spearheaded Red Hat's first **Cloud Operations** team and led the development of core **NFV** and **OpenStack** components, enabling the company's strategic expansion into the fast-growing **Cloud Computing** vertical.

Canonical: Engineering Manager - Product Strategy

Sep 2011 - Oct 2012

Reported to the Founder & CEO, leading **Product Strategy** for **Ubuntu**, the OS powering **20M+ users**.

- **Innovation:** Directed the development of core Web technologies (**WebKit, Chromium**) and the porting of **Ubuntu** to smartphones and TVs, defining the strategy for **multi-device convergence**.

Octality: Head of Engineering, Founder

2008 - 2011

Founded the company behind the Cherokee Web Server, then ranked as the world's fastest web server.

- **Global Execution:** Built and led a distributed engineering group across Spain, Mexico, and the USA, delivering high-performance infrastructure solutions adopted by governments and space agencies.

Sun Microsystems: Technical Leader - Solaris Organization

2004 - 2008

Served as Technical Lead for Solaris and Technology Evangelist for the Open Source Software group.

- **Open Source Strategy:** Played a key role in the committee that planned and executed the historic open sourcing of Java and Solaris, while contributing code to GNOME, ZFS, and the Linux kernel.

Espanix: High Performance Computing Engineer

2002 - 2003

European University: Security Engineer

1999 - 2003

Qualifications

MIT: Industry Mentor - Performance Engineering

2019 - 2024

Served as a mentor for Course 6.172, guiding students in the architecture and optimization of high-performance systems, bridging academic theory with engineering insight from hyperscale production.

Johns Hopkins University: Data Science Specialization

2014

Specialization covering R Programming, Data Analysis, Statistical Inference techniques, Regression Models, reproducible research, and modern Machine Learning algorithms. Completed with distinction.

University of Chicago Booth School of Business: Global Senior Management Program

2013

A joint Chicago Booth and IE Business School program focused on strategic innovation, corporate agility, and high-performance leadership in global markets, alongside senior executives across industries and continents.

Complutense University: Ph.D. in Telecommunications

2003 - 2006

Certificate of Research Proficiency. Focus on Advanced Networking, Telematic Engineering, and Distributed System Architectures, developing a novel high-performance architecture, later widely adopted in the industry.

European University: M.Sc. in Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence)

1998 - 2003

Master of Engineering with a dedicated specialization in Artificial Intelligence, Neural Networks, and Knowledge-based Systems, covering natural language processing and formal reasoning.

Royal Academy of Doctors in Statistics: Graduate Diploma in Data Analysis

2001

Diploma in Data Analysis in Experimental Science.